

🔪 Red Pen (static drop-in)

User manual - review notes for any site that renders in a browser. One script tag, no backend, no build.

Version 0.0.10 · July 2026 · by Lincoln Tracy · redpen.tools

What it does

Add one script tag to any HTML page - a Jekyll blog, an Astro site, a React app, a hand-written homepage from 2009 - and it gets the Red Pen overlay: a red button, a notes panel, numbered pins on elements. Notes are stored in the browser's own storage for that site. No server, no account, no build step.

Add it to a page

```
<script src="red-pen.js"></script>
```

Place it at the end of `<body>`. That's the entire setup - it works from a local file, a dev server, or a live site. All configuration happens in the overlay itself.

Leaving notes

Red Pen (static) - demo

This page loads red-pen.js with no server. Look for the red button bottom-right. Add a note, pin one to an element, reload - it persists (localStorage).

A feature block

Pin a note to this heading or paragraph.

Another section

A **2** on

Open "All notes" in the panel to see the cross-page board, export, and import.



A page with the drop-in: pins 1 and 2 anchored to the heading and the button, the red button bottom-right.

Click the red button to open the panel. Type the note, pick a type (Note, Idea, Problem, Question) and priority, and Add - or Ctrl+Enter. **Pin** lets you click the element the note is about; pins are numbered, amber while a note is in progress, and the **J** key jumps between them. Each note carries status (Open, In Progress, Resolved), replies, Locate, and edit.

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The Red Pen panel is a floating window with a red header. It contains a list of notes, each with a status (Problem, Question, Idea), priority (normal, high), and timestamp. Each note has a 'Reply...' button and a 'Reply' button. At the bottom, there is a 'Pin' button, a 'Note' dropdown, a 'Normal' dropdown, and a red 'Add' button. A red button with a pin icon and a '2' badge is located at the bottom right of the page.

Status	Priority	Timestamp	Text	Actions
Problem	normal	Jul 12 5:08 AM	Body copy runs long on phones - tighten the second paragraph	In Progress, Edit, Delete, Reply...
		Jul 12 6:00 AM	Half done - first cut is in	Reply...
2 Question	normal	Jul 12 5:04 AM	Button label reads odd - "Try the demo" instead?	Locate, Open, Edit, Delete, Reply...
1 Idea	high	Jul 12 5:00 AM	This heading should mention the launch date	Locate, Open, Edit, Delete, Reply...

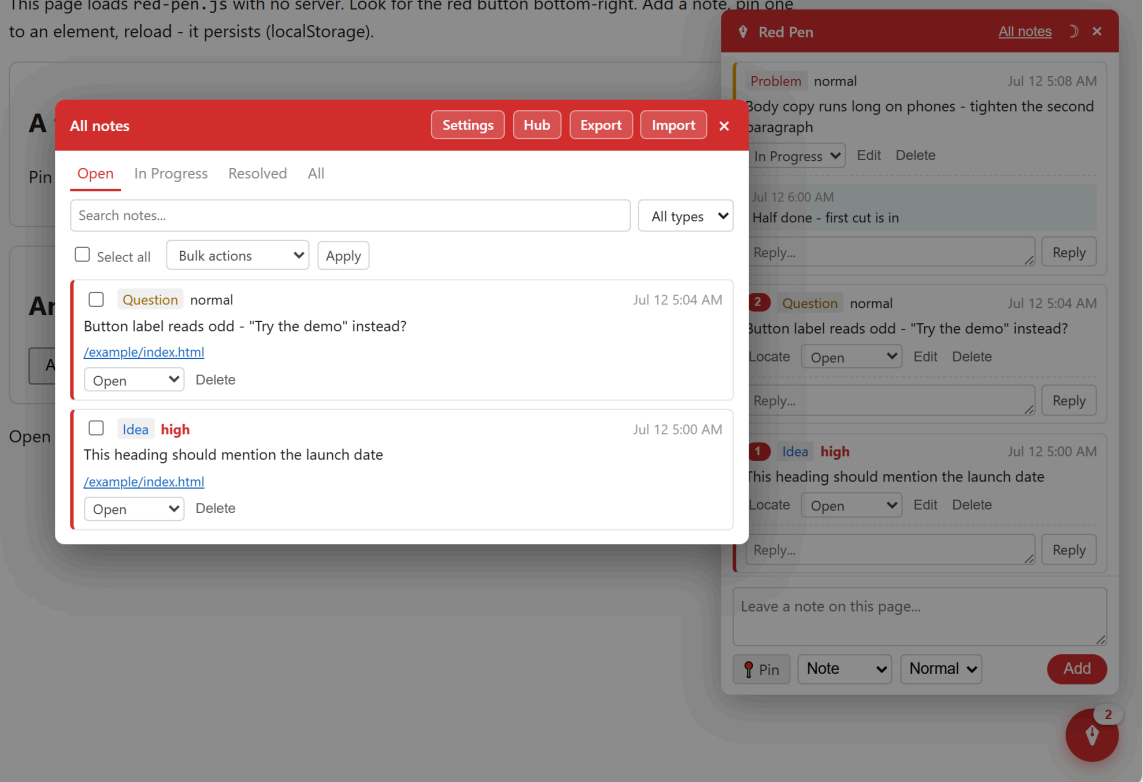
The panel on the demo page, with the notes for this page.

The All-notes board

All notes in the panel header opens the cross-page board: every note on the site, status tabs, search and type filters, bulk actions (resolve, reopen, delete several at once), and page links that navigate to where each note lives.

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The All-notes board with tabs, filters and the bulk bar.

The board's header also holds **Settings** (custom note types, custom pin color), the dark-mode toggle, and **Export / Import**.

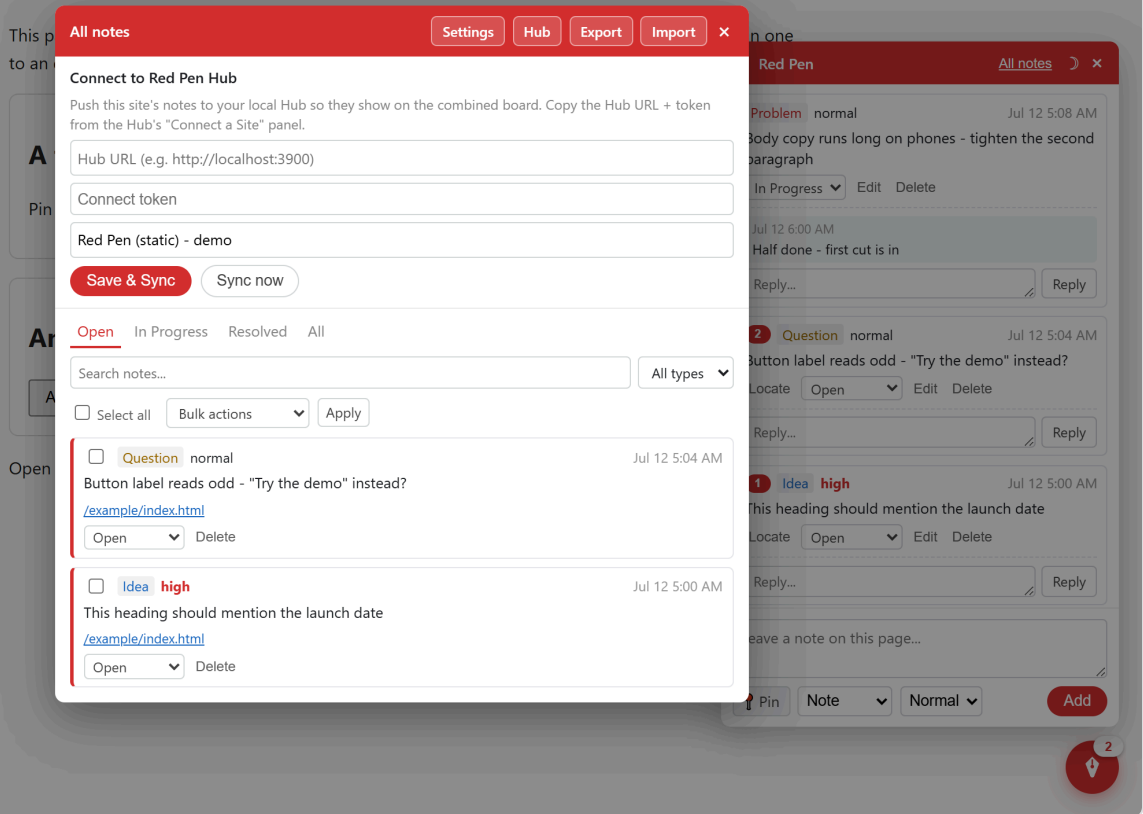
Where your notes live - read this one

Notes live in this browser, on this machine, for this site. The store is the browser's localStorage. Clearing site data deletes your notes, and a different browser or computer won't see them. **Export regularly:** the Export button downloads all notes as a JSON file you can back up, hand to a teammate, or Import on another machine. If you want notes that live outside the browser, that is exactly what the Hub connection or the Express middleware are for.

Push to the Red Pen Hub (optional)

If you run the free Red Pen Hub, the **Hub** button on the All-notes board takes a Hub URL, connect token, and project name. Save and the site's notes push to your Hub board and pull status changes back - resolve on either side and the other follows. This also rescues notes out of browser storage into something permanent.

Red Pen (static) - demo



The Hub connection fields on the All-notes board.

If something breaks

Symptom	Likely cause and fix
No red button	The script tag isn't on this page, or it sits before <code><body></code> content exists. Put it at the end of body.
Notes disappeared	Browser site data was cleared, or you're in a different browser/profile. Restore from your last export - and export more often.
A pin doesn't show	The element it was anchored to no longer exists on the page. The note is still in the panel and on the board.
Notes don't follow me across pages	They do - per site. The panel shows the current page's notes; the All-notes board shows everything.

Red Pen static drop-in 0.0.10 - built by Lincoln Tracy. Part of the Red Pen family: WordPress, Express, static sites, Blender, Ableton Live, and the Red Pen Hub. redpen.tools